

respectable number by any yardstick. The battery can be charged by connecting the controller to the PS3 through the simple microUSB cable provided with the gamepad. The best part about the battery is that it can be easily replaced once its battery life is up, thus enabling you to save costs on buying a new controller.

In terms of design, very little changed in the transition from DualShock 3 to SixAxis, with Sony retaining the same eight-button layout (Cross, Square, Triangle, Circle, R1, R2, L1, L2), four-way navigational pad and dual analogue sticks. The one change, though, were the R2 and L2 buttons, which now bore a trigger-like mechanism instead of the former rounded edges.

However, at the 2007 Tokyo Game Show, Sony announced that it would be phasing out the SixAxis in favour of the new DualShock 3, which will feature vibrational feedback. Never once addressing all the allusions to motion sensing, Sony's new controller has been widely welcomed by the gaming community.

However, with the vibration feedback, the weight of the DualShock 3 has gone up dramatically, being almost 50 percent heavier than the SixAxis. Sony is now packaging it with most new PS3 units being sold.

PlayStation Eye

Before Microsoft and Nintendo ever got serious with tracking motion-based features for gaming, PlayStation had already been in the market with the EyeToy for PS2. The popular accessory got an upgrade for the PS3, dubbed the PlayStation Eye, which features more sensitivity and faster feedback.

Trumpeting the 'bigger and better' horn, the PlayStation Eye claims to record 640x480 pixels VGA video at frame rates of 60 Hz and 320x240 pixels video at 120 Hz – twice that of the EyeToy.

The camera features a two-setting adjustable fixed focus zoom lens. Selected manually by rotating the lens barrel, the PlayStation Eye can be set to a 56° field of view similar to that of the EyeToy, for close-up framing in chat applications, or a 75° field of view for long shot framing in interactive physical gaming applications.

The PlayStation Eye also has a built-in microphone that can be used for voice



Before the Wii and Project Natal, Sony was already rocking some motion-input games with the PlayStation Eye Webcam